

Informed Consent Form



De La Salle University

Research Study Title Socius: A Chatbot focused on training Pragmatic Competence assessed through Grice's Maxims and Implicatures

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Overview

SociusBot is an AI-powered chatbot designed to support young adults in developing pragmatic communication skills through guided conversational practice. The chatbot engages users in realistic social scenarios grounded in Filipino cultural values and the developmental challenges of emerging adulthood, helping them navigate difficult conversations with clarity, respect, and cultural sensitivity.

SociusBot is intended for Filipino young adults aged 15–24 years old who are currently enrolled in senior high school or undergraduate programs. For this study, we would require at most 20 participants who are comfortable communicating in English and navigating digital applications.

Conversation logs will be collected to monitor how users engage with SociusBot. These logs will include users' responses during scenario-based conversations and their personalized tutoring conversations. These will be used strictly for research report generation.

Purpose of the study

The study aims to develop Socius, an AI-driven chatbot designed to help young adults (aged 15–24) improve their pragmatic competence, or the ability to interpret implied meanings and "read between the lines". Utilizing the APAM (AI Partner-AI Mentor) framework, the system provides a safe environment where users can engage in realistic social simulations and receive feedback grounded in Grice's Maxims. The research specifically explores the potential of Gemini and the GRICE dataset to model these conversational norms in an educational context. Additionally, the study localizes conversational scenarios to ensure they are relatable to the local Filipino cultural context and social dynamics.

Procedure

To participate in this study, we will require **five (5) days** of your time for you to go through the following steps:

- **Informed Consent (30-60 minutes).** You will be given time to review the Informed Consent which outlines voluntary participation, withdrawal, data privacy and confidentiality, and how your data will be used in the study.
- **Pre-Assessment Survey (15 minutes).** Before beginning conversations with the chatbot, you will complete an initial survey to assess your baseline perceptions and communication skills.
- **Conversations with the Chatbot (1 week, minimum 1 conversation per day).** You will engage in conversations with the chatbot for a period of one (1) week. You are required to complete at least one (1) conversation per day, choosing from one of the four scenario themes provided. Each conversation should last at least 10-15 minutes. All conversations will be recorded for later analysis, but no video recording or participant observation will be conducted throughout this period.
- **Daily Post-Interaction Survey (15 minutes per day).** At the end of each conversation, you will complete a brief online survey to reflect on your experience using the chatbot that day, focusing on three key areas: : Performance (the quality of conversation immersion and mentor feedback), Humanity (how natural and human-like the interactions felt), and Affect (your emotional engagement and comfort level during the scenarios).
- **Final Reflection Survey and Chatbot Evaluation (30 minutes).** At the end of the three-week period, you will complete a comprehensive survey evaluating your overall experience, development, and impression of the chatbot.

Risks in Participation

Participants may be challenged by responding to situations they are not comfortable or familiar with.

Benefits in Participation

By the end of this research, participants will be able to reflect on themselves and become more familiar in dealing with various daily situations.

Voluntary Participation

The researchers would like to clarify that participation in this study is voluntary. The participant is obliged to understand that they are allowed to opt out of participation if they feel so, without being penalized. They are also given the opportunity to inquire about questions they may have about the study.

Data Privacy Consent

By accomplishing and answering this form, both parties are obliged to the following:

1. The researchers must:
 - 1.1. Use the gathered information related to the research entitled *Socius: A Chatbot focused on training Pragmatic Competence assessed through Grice's Maxims and Implicatures* for research purposes only.
 - 1.2. Ensure that the information taken from the respondents are kept confidential from external parties.
 - 1.3. All and any information disclosed by the participant regarding the study will remain incognito.
2. The participant must:
 - 2.1. Understand that the information or data collected from this study will be kept confidential and used for research-purposes only.
 - 2.2. Understand the procedures regarding the course and flow of the research.
 - 2.3. Understand that they are obliged and entitled to withdraw from the research at any given time without the need to provide any reasoning and that they will not be penalized for doing so.
 - 2.4. Understand that data that they provide for this study will be anonymized and aggregated with other data to create the research report and/or article.

As such, by filling out this Informed Consent Form, I agree to the following:

- I voluntarily agree to participate in the research.
- I have read and understood the procedures regarding the course and flow of the research.
- I have read and understood the provided information about the research.
- I understand that all data collected from this study will be kept confidential and used for research purposes only.

- I understand that I am allowed to opt-out of the research without having to provide reasoning and that no penalties will be given in doing so.

Signature Over Printed Name

Date Signed